

Usability Study | Core System

Washington, DC
September 2019

Study Information

In this study, Flexion UX Designers performed a usability study with several user groups to test the core system functionality implemented to date. This study included all major user roles, including both internal and external users.

Participants

- Petitions Clerks (3)
- Docket Clerks (3)
- Calendar Clerks (3)
- Judges (3)
- Petitioners (2)
- IRS Attorneys/Admin (2)

Sessions

- 16 in-person sessions on-site at the U.S. Tax Court office
- Desktop setup with attached scanner

Findings | Internal Users

Dashboard / Landing Page

Key Findings

- Messages is the preferred landing page for petitions and docket clerks (although some expected to see the QC first)
- Judge's dashboard layout and information (messages and trial sessions) was clean and to the point
- Judges expect to have more information regarding their pending actions available on their dashboard

Recommendations

- Keep the Messages Individual Inbox as the landing page for internal users (except judges) - (No action)
- Include pending motions on Judge's Dashboard ([Post-MVP #2764](#))

App Navigation

Key Findings

- Users were able to locate the different queues using main navigation without much prompting
- Users are almost always using the browser “Back” button to go to previous screens
- Users encountered several system delays in displaying a screen; user (1) tried to click action button again due to delay

Recommendations

- Consider wayfinding queues for workflows with deeper structures; considering breadcrumbs, in-app “Back” functionality, etc. (MVP - New)
- Investigate system performance and consider additional feedback (progress indicators, etc) for long processes (MVP - New)

Document QC

“With everything in one place it makes job functions a lot easier” - Docket Clerk

Key Findings

- With explanation, users understand the different queues (individual and section) and are able to navigate between the two easily
- Users are able to easily assign work items to themselves and find those items in their individual queues
- Users are able to identify work items that are unassigned, but did not immediately associate the icon with unassigned items
- Users are able to identify “read” versus “unread” work items
- Petition Clerks assume the “case status” means petitions that have not been worked and expect a “pending” indicator when a petition QC has been started

Recommendations

- Add tooltip for icons (Post-MVP - New)
- Investigate/consider in-progress state for petitions during QC process (Post-MVP - New)

Messaging

“That’s easy” - Petitions Clerk, when forwarding a message

Key Findings

- Users understand the different message queues (individual and section) and are able to navigate between them with minimal explanation
- Users understand the read / unread indicators for messages and like the visibility of new message icon in the global navigation
- Judges need more information (case name, status, calendar, sender) on messages in order to prioritize them
- Users want to be able to customize their view of messages by filtering or sorting
- Users are easily able to forward messages, but would like additional actions, such as replying directly to sender, to be easier
- Users were confused when seeing multiple message threads on the Document Detail screen; expect to see the message they need to take action on more clearly

Messaging

Recommendations

- Add case status and sender to Judge's messages inbox (MVP - New)
- Redesign message view on Document Detail screen to prioritize the selected message; allow access to other user messages as a secondary action (MVP - Add to #2448)
- Add ability to sort messages by read/unread (Post-MVP)
- Add direct "Reply" ability to messages (Post-MVP)

Creating a Case (Paper Petitions)

Key Findings

- Users complete the case form using a combination of tabbing and mouse navigation
- Users worked directly off of the physical petition and completed the entire form before attempting to scan
- Users easily navigated to each document tab (Petition, STIN, RQT)
- Users were able to easily enter all necessary data into the form
- Users expected place to enter / add information for the Application for Waiver of Filing Fee
- User hesitation around trial location, confused if this was a required field
- Party contact information did not populate / retain data as expected when party type was changed
- Users were confused about the difference between case caption and petitioner name

Creating a Case (Paper Petitions)

Recommendations

- Add Application for Waiver of Filing Fee as document included during case creation (MVP - New)
- Retain data in contact information fields when party type is changed (Post-MVP)

Training Considerations

- Ensure users understand trial location is only required when Request for Place of Trial document is included
- Ensure users understand the new workflow around correcting a case caption and the Order for Ratification
- Ensure users understand the new workflow regarding the Admissions process

Petition QC (Petition Clerk)

Key Findings

- Users expect a summary screen of all information before the petition is batched for IRS (similar to Petition Review page for external users)
- User (1) expected to see the address, instead of Country field, immediately following petitioner name
- User (1) had difficulty with the two scrolling panels; did not realize the left panel scrolled
- Users expect additional information available on the list of batched/served petitions: who completed the QC, what documents are included with the petition, how many pages
- Users were able to locate batched and served petitions and understood the various Document QC boxes
- Users were able to easily serve petitions
- Users were easily able to recall petitions and the recall workflow functioned as they expected

Recommendations

- Add “Batched By” information to the Petition QC Section Served tab (MVP - Add to 2019)
- Add a general summary screen with all petition information (and orders needed) prior to adding to batch (Post-MVP)
- Add details on what is included in the petition batch: other documents included with petition, number of pages within each document (Post-MVP)

Add Docket Entry (Docket Clerk)

Key Findings

- Users were easily able to locate how to add a new docket entry
- Users were easily able to complete a new docket entry, and the form included all the expected fields
- User (1) requested the “Additional Info” fields to show more characters; they sometimes enter in multiple lines of information and would like to more easily see the entire text
- User (1) expected the date field to auto-tab to the next field; users use varying formats to enter dates, using leading zeros about half the time
- Users entered all data, saved, and then added the scanned documents, but understood that the system would allow for a more flexible workflow
- Users understood that without adding a document the docket entry would show as “incomplete”
- Users were pleased with how the information was generated on the cover sheet

Recommendations

- Change the “Additional Info” fields on the Add Docket Form to text area fields to allow more visible characters (Post-MVP)

Scanning (Petitions and Docket)

Key Findings

- Users did not identify “Add Batch” as the action to start scanning documents; had trouble figuring out how to begin to scan
- Users were able to easily scan documents, and understood that the system required documents to be scanned individually
- Users were able to easily create PDFs from their scanned documents
- Users expected to be able to scan multiple documents at one time (current functionality); and expressed concern over this change in process
- Users expected the ability to delete and replace individual pages within a PDF (current functionality); however, their stated workflow does not include a comprehensive quality check of each page
- Users would prefer more efficient way to review the scanned documents; clicking through each page is cumbersome
- Users need to be able to scan via the scanner flatbed and scan two-sided documents
- Users review the scan documents based on page count; they manually count physical pages and confirm the number matches the scanned document

Scanning (Petitions and Docket)

Recommendations

- Update language and priority of the “Add Batch” action; options include updating language to “Start Scan” or “Add Document”, changing the style to a primary button, co-locating the action with the scan selector (MVP - New)
- Add functionality for flatbed and two-sided scanning (MVP- New)
- Update the scan review panel to show a scrollable list of thumbnails for scanned pages (Post-MVP)
- Add ability for user to enter the expected number of pages a scan should contain (to verify the scan is complete) (Post-MVP)
- Investigate need for multiple document scans and individual page deletion/replacement. While this was expressed as a concern by all users, their stated QC process does not indicate an actual need for these features. (Ongoing- Post-MVP)

Case Detail

"It's way up here and it's really small" - Judge, regarding case caption

Key Findings

- Users had difficulty locating the case status and case caption
- Users are able to locate petitioner contact information easily
- User (1) was confused about the IRS Notice date; would expect it to be the date the petition was due based on timeliness
- Users would like to see which documents have not been QC'd easily on the docket record
- Users expressed confusion regarding columns on the docket record (parties, action, filings and proceedings)
- Users would like to be able to filter and sort the docket record more easily and by more data points
- Users easily understand what is included under Draft Documents
- Iconography on the docket record is not immediately understood, but make sense to users upon explanation
- Users expected to be able to edit a docket entry (#991)
- Most users did not notice the Messages in Progress section on the Case Detail page
- User (1) expected to see a comments section on the Case Detail page for notes and other information (#675)

Case Detail

Recommendations

- Add indicator for docket entries that are awaiting QC; these could be treated the same or similar to incomplete docket entries (MVP- Add to #991)
- Consider adding the timeliness date (date the petition was due) along with the IRS Notice date (Post-MVP)
- Add additional sort and filter options for the docket record (Post-MVP)
- Add tooltip for icons on the docket record (Post-MVP)
- Consider a redesign of the Case Detail page after core functionality is implemented (MVP-New)
- Ensure labelling on the docket record matches users expected language (*See training consideration)

Training Considerations

- Users were confused about the language on the docket record; they may not currently understand the labelling on the existing docket record

Document Detail

"Think of your email with a preview window and operate window." - Judge, regarding navigating between documents on the docket record

Key Findings

- Users want to be able to easily switch between the detailed view of documents on the docket record
- Users are able to easily scroll through PDF document

Recommendations

- Allow users to more easily navigate between documents on the docket record, without having to go back to the Case Detail and select another document (Post-MVP)

Trial Sessions (Calendar, Judges)

"You have everything we'd have on the paper calendar" - Calendar Clerk

Key Findings

- Trial sessions layout and organization was clear to users
- Users did not immediately see the swing session iconography, but with explanation, understood the association
- Users expect trial location addresses to either pre-populate or be available to select from as well as custom address fields; they expressed concern over manually entering in addresses for all locations
- Users were able to easily add a new trial session
- Users expect a way to easily edit trial session information (#1900)

Recommendations

- Add tooltip for swing session icon (Post-MVP)
- Add known court addresses to database to support prepopulation of trial locations (Post-MVP)

Setting Trial Session (Calendar)

"Once I hit that one button it's a done deal? That's cool!" - Calendar Clerk

Key Findings

- Trial Session detail includes all the expected information
- Users expect a way to indicate on the case list if a case has been reviewed and is ready to set
- Users expect easy wayfinding between case detail page and trial session list
- Users expect cases that are flagged not be set to be automatically removed from the case list
- Users are easily able to print the calendar
- User would like to track when a session's notices will be sent

Recommendations

- Allow users to mark if a case has been reviewed and is ready to set for trial; show indicator cases that have been reviewed versus cases that are awaiting review (MVP - #1925)
- Allow users to remove cases that should not be set for trial from the eligible cases list; this could be automated based on case status (MVP - #1188, #1196)
- Allow visibility into when trial notices should/will be sent, and indicators for sessions that have been issued notices (MVP - #1193)

Session Working Copy (Judges)

Key Findings

- Users did not find switching between the Working Copy and Session Detail screens intuitive; did not understand the difference between the two versions; language is not clear
- User (1) expects all tables to be sortable and customizable by all data points
- Users did understand some of the trial statuses; trial statuses provided were not what they would expect and would not be helpful prior to calendar call
- User (1) expects to be able to easily see their “active cases”, meaning only the cases they need to call during the calendar call
- Users are able to easily add and view case and session notes
- Users expressed conflicting concerns over the privacy of their notes

Session Working Copy (Judges)

Recommendations

- Update the list of trial statuses to include statuses that are meaningful and beneficial to judges prior to calendar call (MVP - New)
- Update language and consider changing visual treatment of the session detail toggle to clarify that this will open the official (complete) trial session case list (MVP - New)
- Allow users to customize the Working Copy by additional sort and filter options (Post-MVP - #2767)
- Allow judge users to select their note privacy preferences and opt in/opt out of sharing notes with other users (Post-MVP #338, #1685, etc)

Findings | External Users

Dashboard (IRS, Petitioner)

"[Cases] are easy to find without searching"- IRS Clerk (talking about cases)

Key Findings

- New look and functionality takes a step away from old process and makes it easier to get the job done.
- Users state they like that all the cases are there, the case numbers - understands that My Cases are cases. "They are easy to find without searching"
- Would be good to know cases that have deadlines, If case is calendared for trial. Court deadline for filing a doc - good to see on table. Ordered - newest filed on top. things with deadlines at top
- User (petitioner) expected information on how to contact the court if there was a problem

Recommendations

- Indicate on external dashboard if a case has deadlines and if case has been set for trial (Post-MVP - #534)
- Provide easy access to court contact information for external users (Post-MVP)

File a Petition (Petitioner)

“The processes are very simplistic in general. I like things spelled out and some of the terminology could be easier for all users” -Petitioner

Key Findings

- Users logged in and instantly finds the action to click file petition button
- Users read and understood all of the instructions on the “before you begin” page
- User (1) states that the tips page has the perfect amount of information. User likes that title says “TIPS” however before continuing to the next step that “Tips” could be renamed as FAQ or instructions for easier use.
- User was confused by the name of the form; instructions reference USTC Form 2, but the linked form footer says TC Form 2
- User was confused about the conflicting PII information regarding the STIN; commented that the info should be included before you reach the STIN upload; she either missed or did not understand this information on the Before you Begin page
- Users overall were easily able to complete the petition form
- Users found the helper modal on case procedures very helpful, but would prefer to have a more detailed description of what a regular case entails

File a Petition (Petitioner)

Key Findings (continued)

- User expected an easy way to edit the petition form from the review screen; did not like having to step back to edit
- User expected information on how information will be communicated electronically - want to be spelled out and up front when the petition is first filed
- Would be helpful to let the user know to “fill out form/save” before continuing file

Recommendations

- Additional testing for filing a petition with pro-se petitioners (MVP - New)

Case Detail (IRS, Petitioner)

Key Findings

- Users overall thought the information on Case Detail page was sufficient
- Users had difficulty locating the Case Information tab at first; once there, they found the information needed
- Users want to see service parties; could be more accessible
- Users (Petitioners) immediately noticed the filing fee info and expect more information regarding filing fee and waiver options to be included in the petition
- Users had no issues with documents opening in a new tab; they were able to navigate to documents and back to system easily
- User was confused when seeing documents on the docket record that could not be viewed (i.e. when they are not associated with a case)

Recommendations

- Include filing fee payment and waiver options as part of the petition form (MVP- #836)
- Consider a redesign of the Case Detail page after core functionality is implemented (MVP- New)

Before You File (IRS)

“Sometimes attorneys label things different then in the system”. -IRS Clerk on supporting documents

Key Findings

- Likes the instructions -there have been times had to ask manager about supporting documents before and it's nice to have on the first page
- Clicks on the Petitioners Guide to e-filing - likes that this is available
- Likes the All Categories - better than current - likes the organization - especially helpful for Motions since there are so many

Recommendations

- None

Filing A Document (IRS)

Key Findings

- User seems to get through interface easy but has some hang ups with wanting what current system has.
- Users expect a printable receipt (similar to cover sheet) with a unique transaction number, whenever a document is filed
- Users would prefer the service information be more upfront during the filing process; they confirm service on all filings and sometimes need to print out service info for proof of electronic service
- Users did not use the typeahead feature on the “Document Type” field; all user scrolled through the dropdown to locate document
- User (1) was confused about filing parties; presuming signed by both parties and filing on behalf of both parties I’m filing the docs, to me it would be I’m filing the document Is it a joint filing / jointly signed? “Joint filing”
- User was confused about redaction information; if the petitioner doesn’t redact their information, the IRS does not redact for them

Filing A Document (IRS)

Recommendations

- Include printable receipt for all document filings, with unique identifier (MVP - New)
- Add helper text regarding typeahead to Document Type field (MVP - New)
- Add service information where relevant in the File a Document form; consider including it with the filing parties or COS (Post-MVP)

Filing A Document (Petitioner)

Key Findings

- User (1) would prefer “Add a Document” to “File a Document” language
- Users read through all instructions on the landing page and all reminders on the form
- Users were confident the filing was successful- sees it on the docket record
- User (1) expected more instructions related to supporting documentation; would want to know when those documents are recommended

Recommendations

- Add helper text regarding typeahead to Document Type field (MVP - New)
- Include additional instructions around supporting documents (Post-MVP)

Summary | Recommendations

Recommendations Summary (MVP)

- Additional testing for filing a petition with pro-se petitioners (MVP - New)
- Consider wayfinding queues for workflows with deeper structures; considering breadcrumbs, in-app “Back” functionality, etc. (MVP - New)
- Add case status, sender to Judge’s messages inbox (MVP - New)
- Redesign message view on Document Detail screen to prioritize the selected message; allow access to other user messages as a secondary action (MVP - Add to #2448)
- Add Application for Waiver of Filing Fee as document included during case creation (MVP - New)
- Add “Batched By” information to the Petition QC Section Served tab (MVP - New)
- Update language and priority of the “Add Batch” action; options include updating language to “Start Scan” or “Add Document”, changing the style to a primary button, co-locating the action with the scan selector (MVP - New)
- Add functionality for flatbed and two-sided scanning (MVP - New)
- Add indicator for docket entries that are awaiting QC; these could be treated the same or similar to incomplete docket entries (MVP - Add to #991)
- Allow users to mark if a case has been reviewed and is ready to set for trial; show indicator cases that have been reviewed versus cases that are awaiting review (MVP - #1925)

Recommendations Summary (MVP)

- Allow users to remove cases that should not be set for trial from the eligible cases list; this could be automated based on case status (MVP - #1188, #1196)
- Allow visibility into when trial notices should/will be sent, and indicators for sessions that have been issued notices (MVP - #1193)
- Update the list of trial statuses to include statuses that are meaningful and beneficial to judges prior to calendar call (MVP - New)
- Update language and consider changing visual treatment of the session detail toggle to clarify that this will open the official (complete) trial session case list (MVP - New)
- Include printable receipt for all document filings, with unique identifier (MVP - New)
- Add helper text regarding typeahead to Document Type field (MVP - New)
- Investigate system performance and consider additional feedback (progress indicators, etc) for long processes (MVP - New)
- Change the “Additional Info” fields on the Add Docket Form to text area fields to allow more visible characters (MVP- New)
- Consider a redesign of the Case Detail page after core functionality is implemented (MVP-New)

Recommendations Summary (Post-MVP)

- Include pending motions on Judge's Dashboard (Post-MVP #2764)
- Add tooltip for icons (Post-MVP - New Story)
- Consider draft-state/in-progress state for petitions where QC has been updated (Post-MVP - New Story)
- Add ability to sort messages by read/unread (Post-MVP)
- Add direct "Reply" ability to messages (Post-MVP)
- Retain data in contact information fields when party type is changed (Post-MVP)
- Add a general summary screen with all petition information (and orders needed) prior to adding to batch (Post-MVP)
- Add details on what is included in the petition batch: other documents included with petition, number of pages within each document (Post-MVP)

Recommendations Summary (Post-MVP)

- Update the scan review panel to show a scrollable list of thumbnails for scanned pages (Post-MVP)
- Add ability for user to enter the expected number of pages a scan should contain (to verify the scan is complete) (Post-MVP)
- Investigate need for multiple document scans and individual page deletion/replacement. While this was expressed as a concern by all users, their stated QC process does not indicate an actual need for these features. (Ongoing- Post-MVP)
- Consider adding the timeliness date (date the petition was due) along with the IRS Notice date (Post-MVP)
- Add additional sort and filter options for the docket record (Post-MVP)
- Add tooltip for icons (Post-MVP)
- Allow users to more easily navigate between documents on the docket record, without having to go back to the Case Detail and select another document (Post-MVP)
- Add known court addresses to database to support prepopulation of trial locations (Post-MVP)
- Allow users to customize the Working Copy by additional sort and filter options (Post-MVP - #2767)
- Allow judge users to select their note privacy preferences and opt in/opt out of sharing notes with other users (Post-MVP #338, #1685, etc.)

Recommendations Summary (Post-MVP)

- Indicate on external dashboard if a case has deadlines and if case has been set for trial (Post-MVP - #534)
- Provide easy access to court contact information for external users (Post-MVP)
- Add service information where relevant in the File a Document form; consider including it with the filing parties or COS (Post-MVP)
- Include additional instructions around supporting documents on File a Document form for external users (Post-MVP)

Questions | Come on, let us have 'em!

Appendix

Dashboard/ Landing Page

Dashboard/ Landing Page

- Would expect to see the QC screen instead of messages, expects to be able to start the workday, working on new petitions (PC 1)
- User's initial reaction: She expected to see the Document QC as home screen. User stated that that was the first thing she typically went to in the morning after logging into her computer. (PC-1)
- Where would she find new petitions - at first, expects them to be in the Messages Inbox; Clicks on QC - understands the difference between QC and messages once prompted (PC-2)
- Would prefer to see Messages on login - wants to take care of anything pending before starting new petitions (PC-2)
- After login - ok with going to messages screen (PC-3)
- User stated he liked to login to the system and see the messages as his homepage. He stated that it was nice to see items that required attention on the first page. (DC-2)
- Upon login the user was not sure how the Inbox Messages related to her and her job. Once explained she was pleased with the functions and layout of the Messages. (Calendar)
 - "I'm just used to the old system. Usually have to bounce back and forth?"

Judge Dashboard

- Stated the layout and information was clean and to the point.(Judge)
- "I like the idea of on my dashboard to have messages, easy to get to trial session and then drop menus and easy search. I frequently will go in and search for an individual case. Yean, that works for me." (Judge)
- Looking to see all of his pending motions - things waiting for him - (all pending motions) (Judge G.)
- Motions filed that he hasn't ruled on - have action either granted or denied - wants to see any that don't have this action (Judge G.)

App Navigation

General Navigation

- Finds Document QC easily via main nav (PC 1)
- Uses the browser Back button frequently instead of clicking on global navigation (PC-1)
- Uses browser Back button (DC-3)
- Less clicking, Seems easier (DC-1)
- Commented on lag time a couple times (Judge)

Document QC

Document QC - General

- Thinks what's in the inbox is what the taxpayers have sent in (PC 1)
- Sees that the case status is NEW (PC 1)
- Questions whether the QC has internal messages but doesn't expect them to be all in one place (PC 1)
- Understands the read/unread states - thinks it's helpful to know which ones still need her attention (PC-2)
- Understand the different links - expects docket number to open Case Detail, expects document link to open to the actual document (All)
- Understands document QC is from outside the court - and messages are internal (DC-3)
- User showed Slight confusion on finding new QC documents to begin with and multiple messages.(DC-1)

My Document QC versus Section Document QC

- Understands / expects that the "My Document QC" is only petitions assigned to her; Switching to section qc makes sense (PC 1)
- User noted she was very pleased it was so easy to reassign items to herself and other users.(PC-1)
- "My Document QC" - doesn't notice the Switch to Section Document QC - thought it was backwards - all petitions versus the assigned petitions (my document QC) (PC-2)
- Initial observation to Document QC section- User showed confusion with navigation. She was in QC but couldn't see mail info. Once everything was pointed out and she navigated around more it became easier for her to get the task complete. (PC-2)
- User stated that the case status needs updating once open it "pending/ in progress" (PC-2)
- Understands the difference between section and my QC - when prompted - didn't immediately notice the switch to my qc (PC-3)
- User Picked up on switching from assigned qc to all qc documents very quickly (DC-1)
- User states "With everything in one place it makes job functions a lot easier" (DC-1)
- User stated that he would like to print a list of items in the Processed tab

Document QC

Icons

- When looking at the Inbox and Document QC User mentioned that tooltip/title tag would be helpful on the icons. It would be helpful to all users since everything is new and would help point out what all the icons means (PC-1)
- The User also suggested we add an icon legend (PC-1)
- Unassigned icons - understands that these mean unassigned - took a little bit to understand - would expect an on hover tooltip or icon legend key (PC-1)
- Easily identifies the petitions that are unassigned - and is able to select them - thinks the icon means something - finds it helpful - easier to see if it's "up for grabs" (PC-2)
- Easily finds the assigned to - and navigates back to the My Doc QC (PC-2)
- Able to identify the unassigned - looks at the column text first but said the icon helps once he knew what it was for (PC-3)
- Does not know what the unassigned icon means (DC-3)
- User stated that it would be helpful if unassigned document titles were bolded to make them "more visible" (DC-2)
-

Case Status

- Expects the case status to show her if she's worked on something or not (PC-1)
- Wants to see indication that a petition is "in progress" (something has been done on the petition) (PC-1)
- The "read" indicator is less important than an "in progress" indicator (PC-1)
- Expects an "pending" indicator on any petitions that she's touched and saved - it's not "NEW" anymore (PC-2)

Messaging

Messaging

- Does not notice Messages in Progress on Case Detail page (PC-1)
- Easily locates the correct docket number and clicks on that but does not click on the Petition link to view the message
- Sees messages in progress - does not click on link without prompting (PC-2)
- Messages make sense (DC-1)
- User seemed to fly through sending email to judge without any trouble and very few questions. (DC-1)

Message Queue Organization

- Understands section messages will include all messages for the section (DC-3)
- Would like to see unread/read indicators, numbers on the section messages too - wants to know if something has been opened and worked on (DC-3)
- Would like filter/way to see just the unread messages (DC-3)

Document Detail - Messages

- Thinks the petition link will just show her the petition, not the messages (PC-2)
- Doesn't see the highlight on the message he clicked on - had a hard time figuring out which message he was responding to (DC-3)
- Multiple messages - having a hard time distinguishing between message cards- sees that they are separated but not 100% intuitive (DC-3)

Messaging

Iconography

- Understood the “unread” messages number after explanation (PC-1)
- User noted that the icon next to messages was a good indicator for new messages however at first thought it was all messages not just inbox (PC-1)
- User was very pleased on how easy it was to send a message and the navigation in order to do so. (PC-1)
- In the header- understands that the icon means unread (new) messages “That’s good” (PC-1)
- Understands the unread/read status indicators (DC-3)

Forwarding a Message

- Sending message on to judge- no issues - “That’s easy” (PC-1)
- Expects a new message to start a new message thread (PC-1)
- After hitting sends, would expect to return to the QC screen (PC-1)
- Able to easily find the message she sent - navigating to the Messages and Sent (PC-1)
- Views the message and understands how to forward on - easily finds the right user (PC-2)
- Clicks on the Sent tab to view the message she just sent (PC-2)

Creating a Case (Paper Petitions)

Navigating

- Quickly goes to Document QC- and clicks the Create Case button to begin the case (PC-1)
- Looking for something to take her to the “main screen” - clicks around all navigation (PC-2)
- Expects to see a main action in the header (“Petitions” or “New Petitions”) (PC-2)
- Wants to see the create case outside of the QC - accessible anytime (PC-2)
- Expects to be directly taken to QC screen after case is created- no problem clicking around and checking the needed orders (PC-1)

Data Entry

- Enters info from off of paper docs themselves (does not scan first) (PC-1)
- Uses both mouse and keyboard tabs when working (PC-1)
- User was confused by the Fee payment id?? (this might need a tooltip/title) (PC-1)

Dates

- Adds leading zeros to dates (09/13/2019) (PC-1)
- Does not enter leading zeros (PC-2)

Creating a Case (Paper Petitions)

Caption

- Does not add "Petitioner" to the Case Caption (PC-1_
- Selects Petitioner and Spouse easily, no questions about party types (PC-1)
- Doesn't understand why the case caption would be different from the name - expects to make all of the changes they need while they are entering in the petition information (PC-1)
- Does not enter , Petitioner in caption (PC-2)

Trial Location

- Trial location - at first wants to enter in something - maybe need more indication that this is not required unless document is uploaded (PC-2)

Party / Contact Info

- Would expect that if you filled in petitioner information, then changes party type that the data entered would be retained - form currently clears when new party type is entered (PC-1)
- User stated that she would like the form fields for party type filled in when/if changing the party type. " It would save time if fields stayed populated" (PC-1)
- Does not notice that the left panel scrolls, can't see address at first and expects to see address fields (PC-2)
- Expects zip code validation (PC-2)

Adding Documents (Scanning)

- Hits submits before uploading - sees error (PC-1)
- Doesn't immediately click add batch - but "scanning document" is what she would expect for language (PC-1)
- Works through all of the filings / clicking through each document tab (PC-1)
- Can navigate between the document tabs - finds STIN easily to add that document (PC-2)
- Clicks create case - gets error to upload petition (PC-2)

Petition QC (Petition Clerk)

Petition QC Workflow

- Had trouble understanding a new workflow; Expects to put on her “stamps” - served stamps, address used by court, etc. (PC-2)
 - Do we need this “Address” stamp? Would the address input in the system automatically be the “address used by court” ?
- User noted “If we have an attorney on the case it needs to go to admission to get admitted/not admitted first before sending to IRS” (PC-1)

Party Information

- Expects to see the address right after the name - not the Country - they don't get that many international addresses (PC-2)

Orders

- Order for Ratification - expects to be able to identify which petitioner didn't sign (do we need this?) (PC-1)
- Expects to see a place to see Application for Waiver Filing Fee- should add to the Petition upload screen ?? (PC-1)
- Expects to see the Application of Fee Waiver as a doc and payment information (paid / not paid) (PC-2)
- Would like a summary screen of all the information - with orders before the petition is batched for irs (PC-2)

Serving the Petition

- When complete the QC process, clicks the Serve to IRS, no issues (PC-1)
- Able to locate the petition she just batched in the Batched for IRS (PC-1)

Batched Petitions

- Wants to be able to see who Served the petition - would like to be able to display Served By (essentially what user batched the petition) (PC-1)
- Wants certain information about cases on the Batched for IRS (PC-2)
 - What's else is included - how many pages
 - Wants to be able to easily print the batched for irs list

Recall Workflow

- Understands the Recall process and is able to recall the petition - this is what she would expect (PC-1)

Petition QC (Petition Clerk)

Case Detail

- Couldn't find the case status - missed completely at first; after having it pointed out says it's helpful (DC-2)
- User stated that the Case Summary could use the comment section to add in other information (DC-1)
- User stated that Case information should come before docket record in tabs (DC-2)
- User would like to see everything that needs to be QC'd separate from ones in progress (DC-2)

Case Info

- Able to locate petitioner address- under Case Info - logical to have trial session info and other petitioner info there (DC-3)

Docket Record

- Wants to see on the docket record what has been QCed or not (DC-2)

Add Docket Entry

Data Entry

- Wanted to see more text box areas on qc form (for additional info text boxes) for longer items so field didn't scroll right to enter long text (DC-1)
- User mentioned that Date fields would be easier to navigate if they auto tabbed to the next. (DC-1)
- While working through filing a document the user's workflow was to fill in all the information first then save. Once saved user went back into the document and scanned paperwork. (current process of entering data.)
- Understands that without adding a document to the docket entry - "the yellow button would come up" - showing that it's an incomplete entry (DC-3)

Scanning (Petitions and Docket)

Starting a Scan

- Does not notice/understand the Add Batch will start the scan (DC-3)
- Able to add a second batch - doesn't think at first that is the right button (DC-3)
- Add batch wasn't clear at first to him (or petitions clerks) as the way to start a scan (DC-1)
- User was confused by the wording "Add batch" and asked questions on scanning document. Once "Add Batch" was for scanning the document user stated the terminology was new to him but made sense. (DC-1)

Scan Workflow

- Would normally scan the petition and then fill out the data (PC-1)
- Would prefer to be able to scan all documents all at once and attach them where they need to go (their current process) (PC-1)
- User stated that she would like to scan documents at one time, save separately and then move (drag and drop) where needs to go as go through. This was the process she was using now. (PC-1)
- Currently they scan everything at once and attach, believes there could be less errors by scanning each document separately (PC-1)
- Scans all documents together - expects to be able to do this and then attach documents to each doc (PC-2)
- Concerned about not being able to delete/rescan a single page at a time (DC-1)
- Manually counts them out and then scans them to make sure there are 30 in the PDF (DC-3)
- FALSE EQUIVALENCY - they want to ensure all pages are there but don't do quality check of each page. Only compare the page counts, yet wants very granular way to rescan a single page at a time (all)

Reviewing Scanned Batches

- Adds batch and pages through each page (PC-2)
- Prefers to see the thumbnails all at once - wants to see if a page is missing or did not scan correctly; does not like to have to page through each page individually - petitions are often many pages (PC-2)
- Wants to be able to delete individual pages from a scan - doesn't want to have to delete a whole batch (PC-2)
- Inability to delete single pages is a concern - they are scanning large documents and sometimes want to just replace one page (DC-1)
- Usually scans documents in batches of 20-25 pages- checks the page count (does not look at each page) and would have to rescan a batch if there was a page missing - sounds ok since he would be able to do this before creating the pdf (DC-3)
- Wasn't sure if doc was actually attached after uploading from a draft state - possibly clear the "you still need to attach a doc" alert after "create PDF" button is clicked - clear error state before they complete the entry again (DC-1)

Scanning (Petitions and Docket)

Scanning Options

- Needs to scan the envelope and use the flatbed - gets Hopper is empty - need a way to change the scanner input (from flatbed to multi scan) (PC-2)
- need to account for two-sided scanning and flatbed scanning (DC-3)

Completing a Scan

- Green Check on Petition lets her know it's complete; User was pleased with the Icon on tab lets you know that process is complete (PC-1)
- Understands what "rescan" means (PC-1)
- Easily finds and clicks "Create PDF" (PC-1)
- Finds the create pdf to complete the upload (PC-2)
- Understands that "Create PDF" adds the document (DC-3)
- Understands that without adding a document to the docket entry - "the yellow button would come up" - showing that it's an incomplete entry (DC-3)

Case Detail

- Couldn't find the case status - missed completely at first; after having it pointed out says it's helpful (DC-2)
- User stated that the Case Summary could use the comment section to add in other information (DC-1)
- User stated that Case information should come before docket record in tabs (DC-2)
- User would like to see everything that needs to be QC'd separate from ones in progress (DC-2)
-

Case info

- "It's way up here and it's really small" - case name is important; want caption to be larger (Judge)
- Able to locate petitioner address- under Case Info - logical to have trial session info and other petitioner info there (DC-3)
- IRS NOtice date - confused that it was the date the petition was due - would prefer to see the deadline to file a petition (CC-2)
- Seeing that there was no notice provided is helpful so they know if they have to create an order (CC-2)

Docket Record

- Wants to see on the docket record what has been QCed or not (DC-2)
- Doesn't understand parties field because she sees filed by (Judge)
- Action - doesn't know what this column is for.(Judge)
 - "...expect to see lodged. Things I've granted or denied."
- "I want each column to be sortable, not a fixed dropdown." (Judge)
- "I check this frequently." (Service petitioner has indicated) (Judge)
- Needs to be available (correspondence) and in the court's record (Judge)
- User stated that Filter would be very helpful to see working in full. Counting different dockets/sessions by item/case type would be helpful instead of having clerk count. User wanted to know if there was anyway to search for notes? This would be helpful on a session by session basis. (Judge)
-

Draft Documents

- "I'd expect to see draft orders" (Judge)

Document Detail

Document Detail

- "Bounce back and forth between things. (Look at document, look at docket record, go back and forth)" (Judge)
- When viewing doc wanted to nav to other docs easily - suggested 2 panel "preview" from docket record where you click on it and it takes over half of table with preview and you can go through (Judge)
 - Want a master > detail design (like email preview) to move through documents on the docket record
-

Trial Sessions (Calendar, Judges)

Trial Sessions

- User stated that the Trial sessions- very helpful, more on the level where people are. Court reporter is very important “always scrambling around to find out who it is.” (Judge)
- User requested a way to edit trial session. He started that this would be very helpful especially while traveling. (Judge)
- User stated that a number count of different kind of cases would be needed if grid was organized by type. (Judge)
- What would you want to see? (CC-1)
 - "If running calendar--> Broken down - cities that they do calendars in regular or small, the judges name.
 - Drop box for different judges to select
 - Notices - instead of secretaries - a drop box to implement notices in calendar"
- Blue headers - understand what indicating? "Yeah, these are the dates we've set the cases" (CC-1)
- "You have everything we'd have on the paper calendar" Session date, city, judge (CC-1)

Is it helpful? "Yes, we can get rid of the paper calendar."Add New Trial Session

- Doesn't see the Add Trial Session button (CC-1)
 - Thinks the dropdowns are related to the blue button. Selects them then clicks the button.
- User 2 followed the test scripts with little issues. It seems that when given specific directions within the “add trial session” she had more freedom and control over the system, still asking questions but navigating more freely. (CC-3)

Trial Locations

- Asks about dropdown of all the addresses - "Yeah, we have it now" There's a custom way for them to add the addresses themselves. (CC-1)

Swing Sessions

- Do you see how it's indicated to be a swing session? "Yeah, I see it." Sees the icon and knows that they're related. (CC-2)
- User 2 stated confusion with the link icon on swing state locations. Once explained and shown how it shows a link between locations she was pleased with design. User also stated it might be good to have tooltip to give more information (CC-3)

Setting Trial Session (Calendar)

Eligible Cases / Setting Calendar

- Includes the expected information
- Easy to navigate
- Able to click into each case to review info - Need a way to flag cases that they don't want picked up; "What if it wasn't good? Could we flag it so it wouldn't be picked up?"
- Anything confusing? "Doesn't give you enough information to say if it could be set."
- "Once I hit that one button it's a done deal? That's cool!"
- "What about hybrid." "That's really smooth. I like that. We have to do all sorts of stuff now."
- Flagging something for removal - do you want to see it still or gone? "I'd want it gone."
- How would you print it? Finds it easily.
- Is that what you'd want to see to print. "Oh, yeah. It has all the information it would have."

Eligible Cases/ Setting the Calendar

- "This would actually eliminate the sheets we're using. Wow, that's cool."
- Need a way to create an audit trail as they're going back and forth between eligibility list and the cases. (Back to Trial Session, Next case, etc.)
- From an individual, a way to set it for trail in the trial information section
- User 2 stated that she would like to have a notification sent when a calendar will go out

Session Working Copy (Judges)

Session Working Copy

- User stated that notes from judges should be seen by all/ session working copy. Session working copy- see who has taken action, who has added notes, ask for order to be made. All users see the same on a level so on same page. Free communication would be desired. (Judge)
- 'Switch to session detail' isn't clear. It's not obvious to me that that's the court version of it." (Judge)
- Wants all tables sortable - likes to customize (Judge)
- Didn't understand filters - wanted them grouped by when she'd use them, pretrial, at trial, etc. didn't get "unassigned" or "set for trial" (Judge)
- Whatever I wrote in the calendar should appear here. I want all of my notes in one place, "like one big happy family" (Judge)

Trial Statuses

- User stated that a Category for pre-trial conference desired. pre trial memorandum/ motion to dismiss (PTM - r-respondent P-petitioner) check list (Judge)
- **Trial status labels are confusing to all judges - list does not represent what they expect**
 - "Set for trial - this is something that doesn't make sense to me." (Judge)
 - "Status Unassigned" doesn't make sense on the far right (Judge)
 - "Status unassigned - I guess this is something I haven't assigned a status to yet." (Judge)
 - "Status unassigned - is this something that's trying to do too much. Cases assigned to judges, before we go out on session, we have certain things that might happen. When I get to the calendar - that's when I make decisions about recall or taken under advisement." (Judge)
 - "When I get to the calendar is the only time I'd select Recall or Taken Under Advisement" (Judge)
- Doesn't understand "Set for Trial" because won't know that until calendar call (Judge G)
- Expects to see a "See Active"
- Would not be helpful BEFORE the calendar call, could be useful to replace what he does during the call on paper documents (judge G)
- Would eliminate the trial clerk coming last minute and scratching out the cases that settled, etc. would just filter out anything he doesn't want to see- the purpose of the status is to get him the list of cases that need to be called (judge G)

Session Working Copy (Judges)

Notes

- Wanted to see notes in both places - case detail and working session (Judge)
- Easily understood how to add notes (Judge)
- Concerned about privacy of notes (availability to others in court and chambers) "I don't want everyone in the court to see my notes" (Judge)
- Does not use notes currently in the system - thinks it could be promising and would be willing to try it out (Judge G)

Dashboard - IRS

xGeneral Dashboard IRS

- Likes that all the cases are there - understands that My Cases are cases assigned to that attorney (IRS1)
- User states that the expectation on first page to see case and what needs to be done is well done and will be better able her to see what has been filed and what needs to be done. (IRS1 &2)
- User navigates through the system very quickly will little questions. In some instances she moves a little too quickly and misses to do items.(IRS2)
- The user slows down on pages that seem to be new content to her to read all the information before continuing. (IRS2)

Homepage -Petitioner

- **General Homepage Petitioner**
 - User reads everything on screen before continuing and states he trusts that information entered is going right to federal government.(PET2)
 - Checks paper notice to make sure which notice type she received (PET1)
 - When she pressed myself, thought that the screen jumped too far down - to the second line of the contact form (PET1)
 - Expects her cursor to be in the name field (PET1)

Case Detail

- **General Case Detail**
 - Wants to see service parties (PET1)
 - Case detail - doesn't notice case info tab - finds File a Document link (PET1)

Before You File- IRS

- **General Before you file IRS**
 - Reads through the instructions (IRS1 &2)
 - Sometimes needs to file a document that the attorney has named something else (IRS1)
 - Doc Type - uses dropdown first - doesn't notice the type ahead *** ANswer is not showing as first in dropdown when type ahead is used (IRS1)
 - Likes the sidebar- expects the docs to be links to bring up doc types (IRS1)

Filing A Document

- **General Filing A Document**

- Required fields did not come across as required to user, however she did say she knew which ones were required. (IRS1)
- Button spacing needs fixing (IRS1)
- Don't have electronic service they need the COS - CAN WE AUTOMATE THIS BASED ON SERVICE SELECTION?(IRS2)
- Reminders are the same way - not as relevant (IRS2)
- Has doc name, parties, tax court transaction number and date (IRS1)
- Could we include this on printable docket record (IRS1)
- Case order is ok (IRS2)
- On whistleblower cases - often sealed - he wants to see the name under sealed cases (IRS2)
- Currently all sealed by paper - case entirely behind the seal. So can't even see it on the list of cases. Can't search for it. "This case is sealed" . They'd have to find the paper case for that currently. Get served by paper for sealed cases as well (IRS2)
- PDF opened in new tab - tried to back button to get back, didn't realize it wasn't in new tab at first(IRS2)

Filing A Document cont...

- User was a little confused if upload is really there or if it is correct. Would like to be able to preview file uploaded before continuing process.(PET2)
- User stated that he would like to see information on “file complete” on upload(PET2)
- The type ahead feature not clear to the user. Once instructed, the user states the function makes things a lot easier. (addition of “caption/ title” needed?)(PET2)
- User states that attachments/certification radio buttons a little unclear at first glance(PET1)
- Expects a link to the tax court website(PET1)
- Clicks “Advanced” - takes her to search - doesn’t give her what she’s looking for - has to start over (PET1)
- Sees PII reminder - but is used to a popup that blocks them from moving forward without hitting ok (IRS1)
- Double checks the petition timeliness (PET1)
 - Doesn’t know the definition of “timely” - would like to see that here as well(PET1)
- Good that it reminds you to redact info several times (PET1)
 - PDF review- doesn’t see the pagination first (PET1)
- Expects to receive an email confirmation (PET1)